
File Case #8

Case ID: 88I **Case Title:** The "Perfect Paper Currency" Case **Date:** February 14, 2020

Status: Closed (Local cell dismantled)

Crime Summary: A surge of extremely **high-quality fake €50 banknotes** flooded the city, causing alarm in the banking and commercial sectors. The banknotes passed most standard detection tests.

Modus Operandi (M.O.): The counterfeiters used **high-quality cotton paper** (possibly stolen from a security paper factory) and **offset and intaglio printing techniques** that replicated security features, including the security thread and watermark, almost perfectly. The banknotes were introduced into circulation by making **small purchases in businesses**.

Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect:** A counterfeiter known by the alias **"El Impresor" (The Printer)**.
- **Collaborators:** A network of **"passers"** who distributed the money.

Key Evidence:

- Microscopic analysis of the banknotes revealed a **minuscule imperfection in the micro-printing of the hologram**, consistent across all fake banknotes.
- Surveillance of businesses that reported fake banknotes led to the **identification of several "passers."**
- The paper used, while high quality, had a **slightly different chemical composition** from legal tender paper, detectable with spectrometry.

Forensic Analysis: Chemical analysis of the paper and ink allowed their origin to be traced to a **specific batch of imported printing supplies from Asia**. The imperfection in the hologram served as a **digital fingerprint** to connect all the banknotes to a **single printing plate**.

Resolution: Following the trail of the "passers" led to a **clandestine printing press** in an industrial park. Three people were arrested, and the machinery and over **€2 million in fake banknotes** were seized. "El Impresor," the mastermind of the operation, was not found in the raid and remains at large.